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The *Catalogue Astrochimique de Sections Efficaces d'Ionisation* (CASEI): A Database Of Low Energy Total Ionisation Cross-Section For Astrochemical Purpose

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Abstract

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1 Methodology

The methodology employed in this work is based around the 3-dimensionnal geometry of each molecules.

1.1 Molecular geometry pipeline

One of the most extensive database for chemical species is PubChem (Kim et al. 2025). Practically all of the molecular species present in the database have 3D conformers available to download. The files associated to those conformers, `.xyz` files, consits in the space position of each atom in 3D space. The code employed in this work make a request at PubChem server with the name of the searched molecule and fetch for the 3D structure as for other properties such as the formula. The 3D conformer catalogue of Pubchem was, as their documentation suggests[1], calculated using advanced quantum computational methods of atomic-force fields repultation, with the assurance of a great accuracy between experimental, theoritical and modeled 3D conformers (see Bolton, Kim, and Bryant 2011). In this case, atomic coordinates should already be optimized and no further optimization is needed (see appendix A).

One problem emerge regarding molecules with no 3D conformer available. While they represent a very small fraction of this database, and appears as *niche* astrochemically speaking at first glance, they do represents molecules with a certain degre of interest. For instance, Germane GeH_4 could be present in the atmosphere of giant planets (Corice and Fox 1972; Moses et al. 2020) as well as arsenic bearing molecules (Bezard et al. 1989; Roederer and Lawler 2012). First calculations were initally made using 2D structure (*e.g* with x and y positions and z as vector fullfilled with zeroes), but it was quickly proven to be a wrong approach. While it could be possible to get 3D conformers from other sources (like Jmol ;(Hanson 2010)), it is easier for automated workflow to keep the same source of data.

Thankfully, it is possible to obtain 3D geometry starting from PubChem 2D structures. For that, we used the SMILES id of each molecule. Using the `strainedSMILES2xyz` python package (Demuth, Schnizer, and Svatunek 2026), we can retrieve a coherent 3D structure from the SMILES structure. While this packages is orignially aimed at strained ring system in complex molecules, it was proven to be very effective at converging to accurate 3D geometry (see the discussion section of Demuth, Schnizer, and Svatunek 2026). It uses tools from the `RDKit` python library (Landrum et al. 2025) at the start. Namely, the *Experimental-torsion-knowledge distance geometry* (ETKDG) method proposed by Riniker and Landrum (2015) which relies on atomic distances in order to find equilibrum in force field from each atoms. While `strainedSMILES2xyz` uses ORCA quantum model (Neese 2012) in order to optimize obtained geometry, we choosed to rely on open-source tools to do so. As such, we used the `geometric` optimization package by Wang and Song (2016) for several cycles, in order to get a geometry that takes into account atomic translations and rotations. This optimization is done during PySCF calculations using the Hartree-Fock (HF) method, as described in subsection 1.3. Figure 1 recapitulates the overall workflow employed for those molecules. The molecules that use this pipeline are indicated in grey in table 1. However, an exception was made for sulfur hexafluoride SF_6, as it was proven to be very difficult to converge to a stable geometry that was coherent. As such, and regarding its importance for astrochemistry, the 3D conformer of SF_6 was downloaded from Jmol and used for calculations in that specific case.

[1] https://pubchem.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/docs/pubchem3d

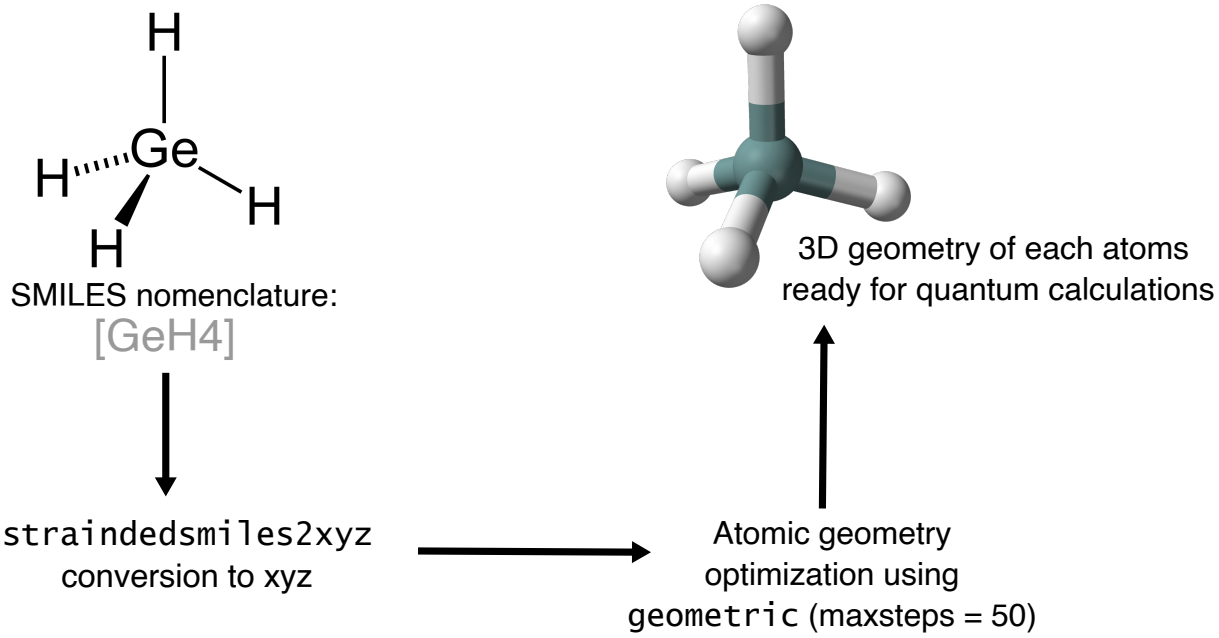


Figure 1 | Overview of the molecular geometry pipeline for molecules without 3D conformer available. Germane GeH_4 is used as an example.

1.2 The BEB method for TICS calculation

The *Binary Encounter Bethe* (BEB) method proposed by Kim and Rudd (1994) as became the standard for theoritical TICS calculations, aswell as being suggested in papers about methods using TICS as parameters (**gautier**). It was proposed as a much simplier model than the *Binary Encounter Dipole* (BED) for ionisation cross-sections calculation. The BEB method estimates the cross-section of total ionisation using the electron energy of the Molecular Orbital (MO) and the kinetic energy of the electron whithin. In application, the BEB method can expressed as, for a distinct MO i:

$$\sigma_i(T) = \frac{S}{t+u+1}\left[\frac{\ln t}{2}\left(1-\frac{1}{t^2}\right)+1-\frac{1}{t}-\frac{\ln t}{t+1}\right] \tag{1}$$

with $t = \frac{T}{B}$, $u = \frac{U}{B}$, where T the ionisation particle energy and B and U are the aforementioned MO electrons and kinetic energy, and S is expressed as:

$$S = 4\pi a_0^2 N_i \left(\frac{R}{B}\right)^2 \tag{2}$$

with a_0 the Bohr radius (0.5292), R the Rydberg constant (13.6 eV) and N_i the number of electrons in the MO. For neutral stable species, N is always equal to 2. This, however, gives the cross section for only one MO. To get the total ionisation cross section, we need to sum all the $\sigma_i(T)$ of each MO, which gives us:

$$\sigma_{TICS}(T) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \sigma_i(T) \tag{3}$$

Concerning T, this parameter is kept at relatively low energy. As it is, intermediates steps of the calculations, *e.g* the σ_i, do not represents partial ionisation cross-section. Jeseněk, Luque, and Lehtinen (2025) explains that and proposed a modified approach of the BEB method for such purposes. We considered 10^3 values in a logscale array with $T \in [10^1; 10^5]$ eV.

1.3 Quantum chemistry parameters calculations

As such, BEB calculations requires the MO electrons energies (B) as well as their kinetic energies (U) . While NIST database propose this parameter for several molecule[2], this is limited in terms of selection. One way is to calculate these parameter. To do that, PySCF quantum chemistry model (Sun et al. 2017) was employed. Using the downloaded geometries, we can input them into the model and obtain the required paramaters. This model is based on the Self Consistent Field (SCF) method of quantum chemistry for the HF approach. The basis-set family used in this work is the Karlsruhe `def2-TZVPPD` basis-set – valence triple-zeta with sets of polarization and diffuse functions (Weigend and Ahlrichs 2005; Rappoport and Furche 2010). Although a quadruple-zeta (QVZ) basis set could have been used, we used a triple-zeta (TVZ) basis set in this work for computational reasons. This type of basis, in particular the `def2-TZVPP` basis, is proven to be reliable for HF modeling for a majority of the periodic table, from H up to Rn (Hellweg and Rappoport 2015; Zheng, Xu, and Truhlar 2011). Several BEB-related papers use either the cross-correlated Dunning Dunning (1989) `cc-` base (Gaches et al. 2024; Kumar 2014) or Pople (Krishnan et al. 1980) gaussian `6-311G` basis (Ali et al. 1997; Hwang, Kim, and Rudd 1996; Scott and Irikura 2005). At our knowledge, this is the first use of a `def2-` basis for TICS calculations. Only Restricted Hartree-Fock (RHF) calculations were performed, as all molecules are neutral and stable and thus have closed shell.

Regarding the energies output of the model, we first assume that B is the absolute value of the lowest electron binding energy of the orbital, *e.g* the first ionisation potential (IP) which satisfies the Koopmans theorem (Koopmans 1934) $B = -\epsilon_i$, with ϵ_i the first ionisation energy of an orbital i. Whilst this is a good approach that is easy to implement and are directly obtained though the HF calculations, this does involve some simplifications as the orbitals are considered as "frozen", meaning that the other electrons do not react to the removal of ionized electron and that the post-ionization orbitals aren't be relaxed. This leads to overestimated first ionization potential for each orbitals (Colonna et al. 2019; Wang, Batool, and Wang 2026; Jeseněk, Luque, and Lehtinen 2025; Scott and Irikura 2005). However, alternative approach such as outervalence Green's function (OVGF; von Niessen, Schirmer, and Cederbaum 1984), coupled cluster (CC, generally single-double-triple CCSDT; Čížek 1966) require higher computational effiort. While some TICS-related papers use those approach (Scott and Irikura 2005; Gaches et al. 2024), the BEB method was historically built around HF method and B, as well as IP, were either experimental values or theoritical values. Furthermore, first ionization potential approach is widely used in other BEB-related papers (Ali et al. 1997; Hwang, Kim, and Rudd 1996; Graves, Cooper, and Tennyson 2021) and do provide accurate results. Gaches et al. (2024) proposed a derived BEB method, namely dBEB, which takes IP values in account to scale BEB TICS as close as possible to experimental data by dampening the impact of high energies of orbitals. The B parameter in relation 1 and 2 can be expressed as :

$$B\prime = B \cdot \exp\left[-1\left(1 - \frac{B}{IP}\right)\right] \tag{4}$$

One way to get accurate IP values are post-HF methods, as direct HF output IP may be too approximate (Scott and Irikura 2005; Wang and Song 2016). We already discussed of complex method such as CCSSD(T) before, but such implementation require large amount of computational power. A less demanding method is to use Density Functionnal Theory (DFT) to overcome the assumptions. We can use the ΔDFT method to calculate the first ionisation potential of an orbital, as, for a given orbital i of an atom N (Wang and Vasilyev 2025):

$$\Delta DFT = E_{i,N^+} - E_{i,N} = IP \tag{5}$$

with E_{i,N^+} the energy of a OM of the cation state of the molecule and $E_{i,N}$ the MO energy of the neutral state. Calculation are done using the Coulomb-Attenuating Method (CAM) with the B3LYP

[2] https://physics.nist.gov/PhysRefData/Ionization/molTable.html

functional (Yanai, Tew, and Handy 2004). Compared to direct HF output, the ΔDFT showcase results much more closer to litterature values, as seen in table B1 in the appendix, where comparison of our calculated IP with IP obtained though other means is made. As seen in this table, HF IP output values tend to be higher than post-HF values methods. Regarding kinetic energy U, this not a direct output of the model and it needs to be derived. As such, U is calculated as:

$$U_i = \mathbf{Tr}\ \mathbf{C}_i^{\mathbf{T}}\mathbf{T}\mathbf{C}_i \tag{6}$$

with $\mathbf{C}_i$ the MO coefficient matrix of the orbital i in the Linear Combinaison of Atomic Orbital (LCAO)[3] formalism and $\mathbf{T}$ the kinetic energy matrix that is composed by elements as

$$\mathbf{T}_{xy} = \langle\chi_x| - \frac{1}{2}\nabla^2|\chi_y\rangle \tag{7}$$

The BEB method, by itself, has limitations for heavy elements, with quantum number $n > 2$ or $Z > 10$ (Graves, Cooper, and Tennyson 2021; Huo and Kim 2000; Ali and Kim 2008; Scott and Irikura 2005). The discrepancy arises because the BEB method uses, as shown in Eq. 1, the kinetic energy of each molecular orbital as a variable. This is problematic for heavier elements, as inner electronic layers of this type have very high kinetic energies. However, ionisation should occur when the electron is far from the centre of the shell, i.e. when it is slower and thus has a lower kinetic energy. An overestimation of the kinetic energy leads to an underestimation of σ_{TICS}. The solution proposed by Huo and Kim (2000), and employed in several BEB-related studies on heavy elements (Graves, Cooper, and Tennyson 2021; Dolg and Cao 2012; Scott and Irikura 2005), is to use the effective core potential (ECP) method. An ECP limits the interaction of valence electrons with the core shell by replacing the latter with analytical functions that represents the interaction between the two. These functions appear as effective potential, while the valence electrons are described by pseudo-valence orbitals that do not penetrate the inner region of the nucleus. In a nut*shell*, the ECP enables the removal of high kinetic energies of core electrons from the BEB sum, as core electrons do not intervene in electronic bonds, which would otherwise artificially minimalize σ_{TICS}. The ECP method can be used in PySCF and, in order to include as many molecules as possible in the database, was implemented in this work. This, however, requires a different basis than the all-electrons Karlsruhe `def2-`, because its related ECP basis only start at Rb ($Z \geq 37$) and thus don't work for lighter elements, *e.g* $3p$ and $4p$ elements. The only basis that has an ECP basis that supports these that is inherently available in PySCF and in the Basis Set Exchange database[4] (Pritchard et al. 2019) is the `crenbl` basis set (Hurley et al. 1986; Fernandez Pacios and Christiansen 1985). More modern basis are available on the open-source Pseudopotentiallibrary[5], as it provides Dunning derived basis combo for both $3p$ and $4p$ elements. For Al, Si, P, S, Cl and Ar bearing molecules, we used the `aug-cc-pVTZ` orbital basis along with its associated ECP basis proposed by (Bennett et al. 2018), whereas for Ge, As, Se and Br bearing molecules we used the same orbital basis and the ECP basis proposed by (Wang et al. 2019). The choices of those basis are also applied to post-HF method discussed earlier. The impact of ECP on TICS calculation is discussed in subsection 2.2. Overall, the whole methodology employed in this work is summarized on figure 2

[3] For a given guess wave function $\phi_j(\mathbf{r})$: $\phi_j = C_{\mu j}\chi_\mu(\mathbf{r})$ with $C_{\mu j}$ the expansion coefficient and χ_μ the atom centered Gaussian basis function.

[4] https://basissetexchange.org/

[5] https://pseudopotentiallibrary.org/

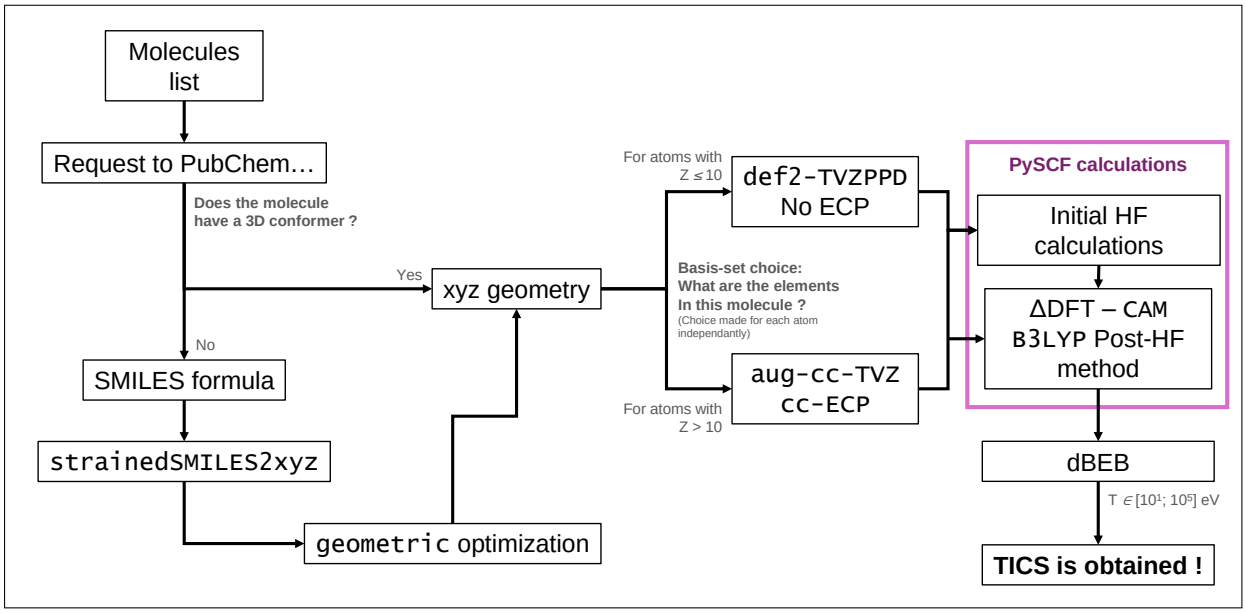


Figure 2 | Overview of the general workflow and methodology employed in this work.

2 Results

2.1 Overview

260 total ionisation cross section of unique molecules have been calculated, and up to 9 isomer for some formula such as C_6H_{12}. The complete list is visible on table 1. On the database website, the user can find the TICS table of each molecule, along with a table with the calculated B and U values for each molecular orbital following the chosen basis aswell as the calculated IP.

Table 1 | List of molecules present in the database. Superscript number indicates the number of isomers. Grey molecules indicates that no 3D conformer was available on PubChem and that the geometry was generated from SMILES structure.

Number of atoms													
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	≥ 14
	AlCl	CHN^2	AsH_3	C_2H_2O	C_2Cl_4	$C_2H_3NO^2$	$C_2H_4N_2$	$C_2H_5NO^2$	$C_2H_5NO_2$	C_2H_7NO	$C_3H_6O_3$	$C_3H_8O_2^2$	$C_{17}H_9N^3$
	AlF	CHP	C_2H_2	C_2H_2S	$C_2H_2O_2$	$C_2H_4O^3$	$C_2H_4O_2^4$	$C_2H_6O^2$	$C_2H_6O_2^2$	$C_3H_6O_2^2$	C_3H_7NO	$C_3H_9N^3$	$C_{16}H_{10}$
	Br_2	CO_2	$C_2N_2^2$	C_2HNO	C_2H_3Cl	$C_2H_4S^2$	$C_2H_5N^2$	$C_2H_6S^2$	C_2H_6OS	C_3H_7N	$C_3H_8O^3$	C_3H_9P	$C_{14}H_{10}$
	BrH	COS	CH_2O	C_3HN^2	$C_2H_3N^3$	$C_3H_2N_2$	C_2H_6	$C_3H_3N_3$	$C_2H_7N^2$	C_3H_8	$C_4H_6O_2^2$	$C_4H_8O^2$	$C_{11}H_{12}N_2O_2$
	C_2	CS_2	CH_2S	CCl_4	C_2H_4	C_3H_3N	$C_3H_3NO^3$	$C_3H_4N_2^2$	C_3H_5NO	C_4H_6O	$C_4H_7N^3$	C_4H_8S	$C_{11}H_7N^2$
	CO	ClNO	$CHNO^3$	CF_4	C_2HCl_3	$C_3H_4^3$	C_3H_3NS	C_3H_5N	$C_3H_6O^4$	C_5H_5N	$C_4H_8^5$	$C_5H_8^5$	$C_{10}H_8$
	CS	FNO	$CHNS^3$	CH_2Cl_2	$C_3H_2O^4$	C_3N_4	$C_3H_4O^2$	$C_3H_6^2$	$C_4H_4N_2^2$	C_5H_6	$C_6H_6^3$	C_7H_5N	C_9H_8
	Cl_2	H_2O	H_2O_2	CH_2F_2	C_4H_2	C_5HN	$C_3H_4N^3$	C_4H_4S	$C_4H_5N^2$		C_6N_6		$C_8H_{10}^3$
	ClH	H_2S	H_2S_2	$CH_2N_2^2$	C_4N_2	CH_4Si_2	C_4H_4	$C_5H_4^2$	$C_4H_6^4$				C_8H_8
	F_2	H_2Se	H_3N	CH_2O_2	CH_2O_3	CH_5N	C_6H_2						$C_7H_8^2$
	FH	HNO	H_3P	CH_2S_2	CH_3NO	N_2O_5	C_6N_2						C_6H_{10}
	H_2	N_2O	HNO_2	CH_3Br	CH_3NS		CH_3ClO_2S						$C_6H_{12}^9$
	N_2	O_2S	HNOS	CH_3Cl	CH_3NSi		CH_4N_2O						$C_6H_{14}^4$
	OSi	O_3	O_3S	CH_3F	CH_4O		H_6Si_2						C_6N_8
				CH_3I	CH_4S								$C_5H_{10}^3$
				CH_3P	H_4N_2								C_5H_{12}
				CH_4	N_2O_4								C_5H_8O
				$CHCl_3$									$C_4H_{10}^2$
				CHF_3									$C_4H_{10}O^4$
				GeH_4									$C_4H_{10}S$
				H_3NO									$C_4H_8O_2^3$
				H_4Si									$C_3H_8O_3$
													C_3N_{12}

2.2 ECP impact on TICS calculation

On table 2 we compared the mean Δ of TICS between ECP and non-ECP calculations for $3p$ and $4p$ elements bearing molecules. We compared the results of the `cc-ECP` basis aswell as with the `crenbl` basis with the `def2-` basis. The mean Δ percentage is calculated, for the peak region ($T \in [10^1; 10^3]$ eV), as:

$$\overline{\Delta\sigma_{TICS}}(\%) = \left\langle \frac{\sigma_{TICS}^{\text{ECP}} - \sigma_{TICS}^{\text{def2-}}}{\sigma_{TICS}^{\text{ECP}}} \times 100 \right\rangle \tag{8}$$

with σ_{ECP} the TICS calculated with either `cc-ECP` or `crenbl`. Figure 3 shows this comparison for

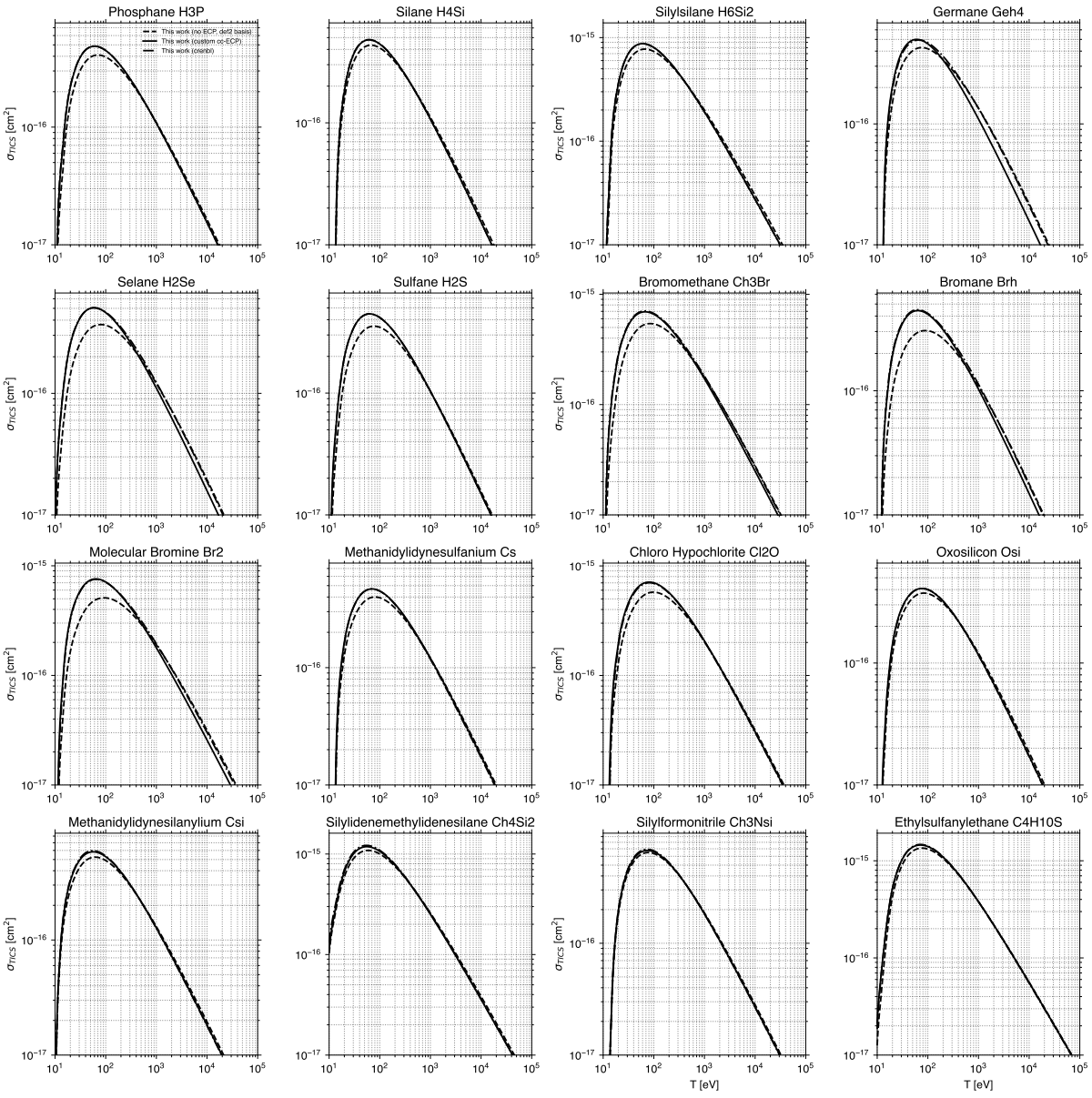


Figure 3 | Comparison of TICS results for several molecule with and without ECP enabled

several molecules. As expected, and as proposed is Huo and Kim (2000) as well as in other BEB-related studies on heavy elements (Graves, Cooper, and Tennyson 2021; Dolg and Cao 2012; Scott and Irikura 2005), the use of ECP basis leads to a higher TICS value. We can see on table 2 that the increase are ranging from roughly 10% for $3d$ elements up to almost 30% for $4d$ elements bearing

molecules. The latter ones -especially- are the one where ECP really affect the whole calculus. For germanium and selenium bearing molecules ($4d$), as well as bromium bearing molecules ($3d$)

The downside of the ECP method is that the removal of core electrons do impact high energy TICS. This can be seen on figure 3 where, for some molecules, the non-ECP curves overlaps the ECP curve. For mass-spectrometry however, the general of the electron is generally in the peak region.

The use of ECP with dBEB shouldn't be a problem as IP is linked to valence electrons and not core, so the mix between the two should work.

Table 2 | Mean Δ of TICS between ECP and non-ECP calculations for $3p$ and $4p$ elements bearing molecules.

	$\overline{\Delta\sigma}$ (%)	
Molecule	cc-ECP	CRENBL
H_3P	13.996	14.568
H_4Si	6.505	7.311
H_6Si_2	9.242	9.283
GeH_4	27.548	32.212
H_2Se	27.384	31.159
H_2S	18.474	16.958
Ch_3Br	20.059	22.418
BrH	24.582	27.666
Br_2	26.276	26.496
Cs	11.996	0.948
Cl_2O	18.123	12.592
OSi	5.703	6.007
CSi	7.079	7.372
Ch_4Si_2	5.093	7.995
Ch_3NSi	2.749	3.753
$C_4H_{10}S$	9.545	9.718

3 Discussion

3.1 Comparison with literature

In order to validate our results, we compared our calculated TICS with several experimental and theoretical data from the literature. Our main benchmark are the values presented in Gaches et al. (2024), as they had done an impressive work of gathering data for a large amount of species.

3.1.1 Hydrocarbons

As pointed out by Hwang, Kim, and Rudd (1996), the BEB method is very efficient for hydrocarbons BEB calculations. As seen on figure 4, our curves fit well to either experimental nor theoritical values. As intented, for some molecules, such as methane CH_4 or acetylene C_2H_2, experimental B values tend to be smaller than theoritical/computed B values (Ali et al. 1997; Hwang, Kim, and Rudd 1996). As such, the cross section obtained through experimental B values tend to be higher,≈10-15%

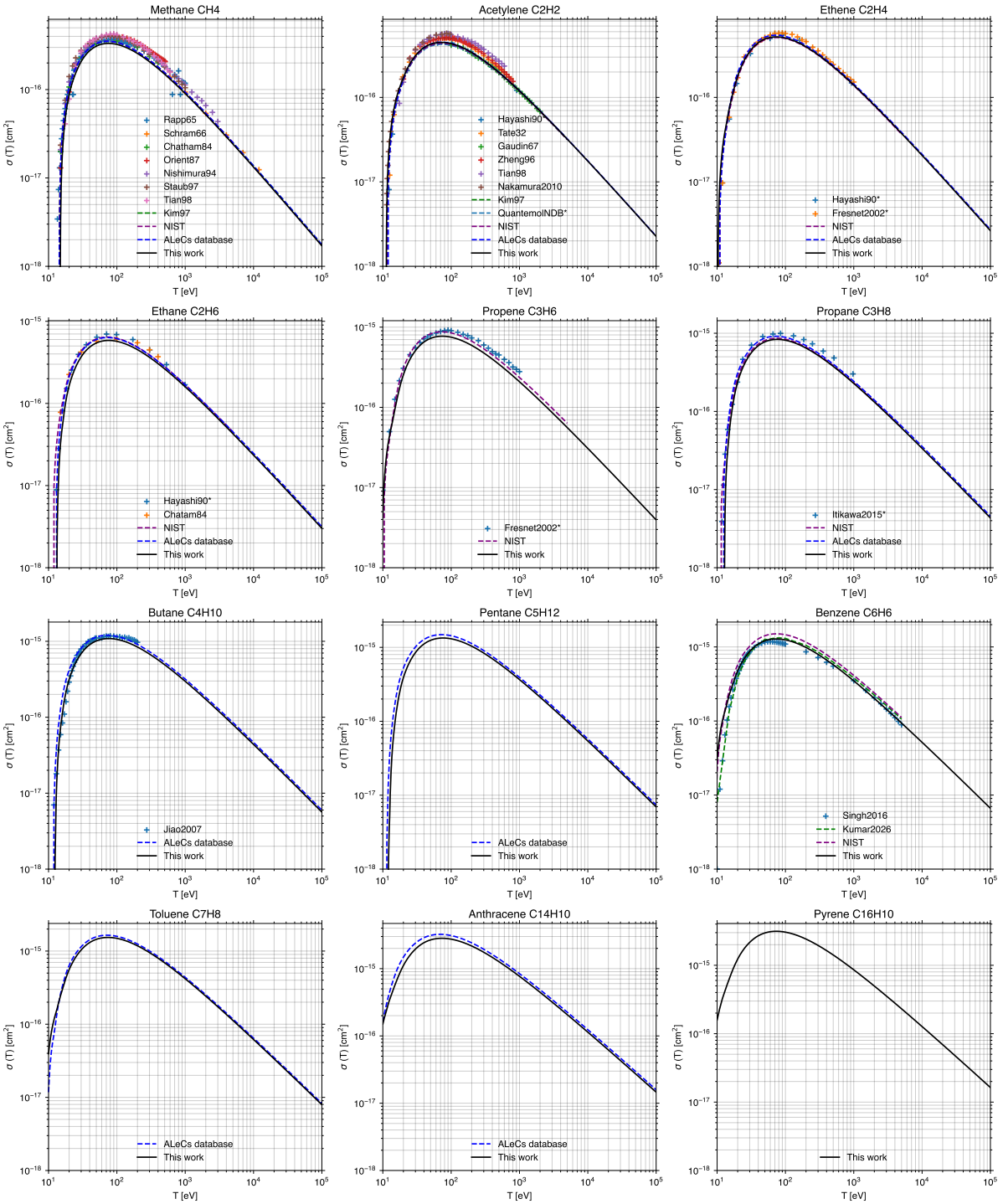


Figure 4 | Calculted TICS for several hydrocarbons. In those plots, σ_{TICS} as been cropped at 10^{-8}. Scatter plot mean experimental data and line plot mean theoritical data. Those data come from Rapp and Englander-Golden (1965), Jiao, DeJoseph, and Garscadden (2007), Chatham et al. (1984), and Ali et al. (1997). The references marked with an * where obtained through lxcat.com database (Dutton 2026; Carbone et al. 2021; Pitchford et al. 2017; Pancheshnyi et al. 2012). Those references include

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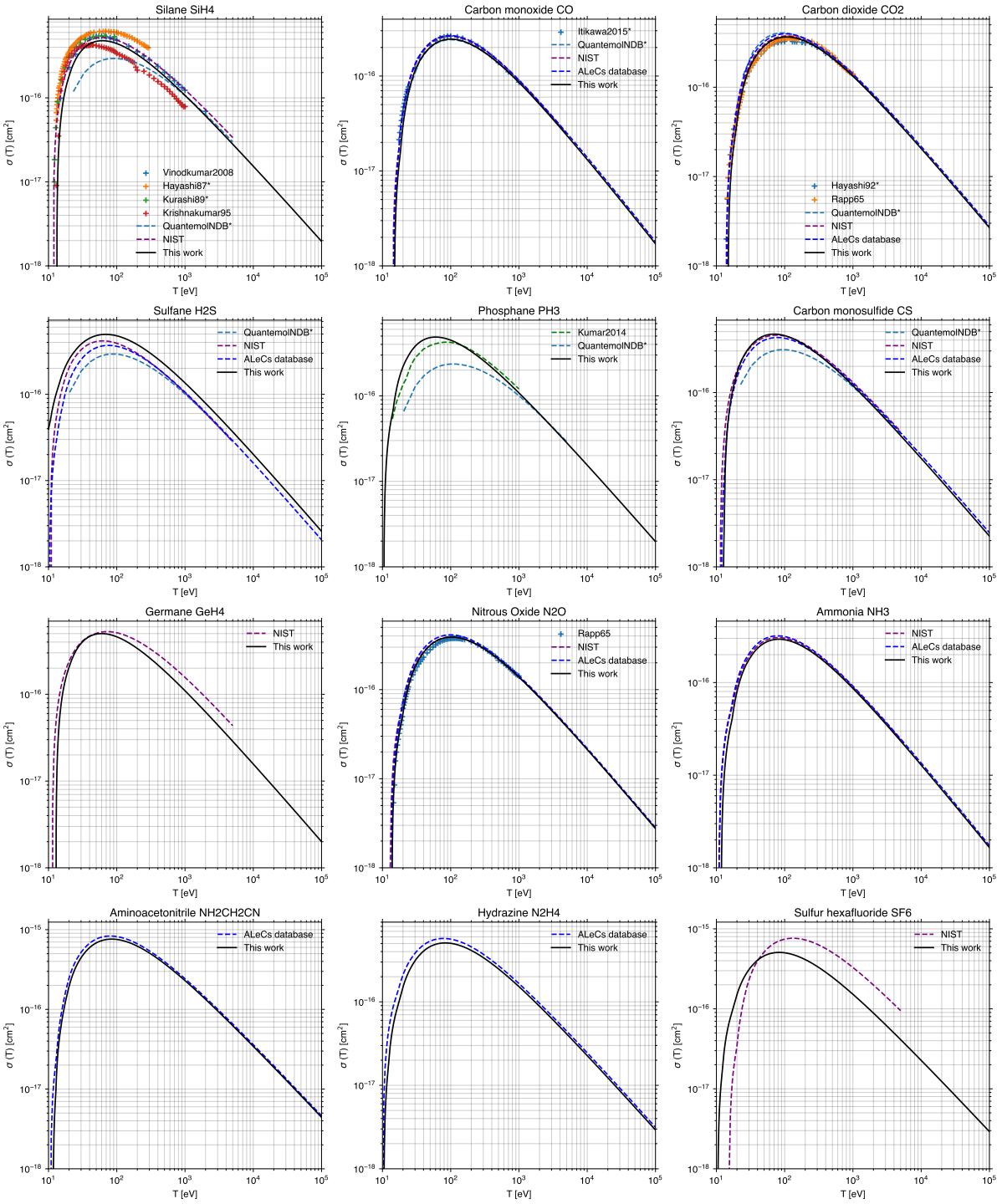


Figure 5 | Calculted TICS for several organic and non-organic molecules. In those plots, σ_{TICS} as been cropped at 10^{-8}. Scatter plot mean experimental data and line plot mean theoritical data. Those data come from Rapp and Englander-Golden (1965), Jiao, DeJoseph, and Garscadden (2007), Chatham et al. (1984), Ali et al. (1997), and Kumar (2014). The references marked with an * where obtained through lxcat.com database. Those references include

at the cross section peak. This is mitigated either by the errorbar of experimental values (that are generally around 20%; Jiao, DeJoseph, and Garscadden 2007) or by the dampening of the dBEB method. Regardless, the data obtained though our pipeline do match litterature data for hydrocarbons.

Aromaticity shouldn't, in theory, impact BEB calculations. As such, we modelised a few polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons (HAPs) in the database. Like Gaches et al. (2024), from the most simple benzene C_6H_6 to pyrene $C_{16}H_{10}$. The biggest present in Gaches et al. (2024) is anthracene $C_{14}H_{10}$. In that case our data have pretty good relation with litterature data. The historical papers of the beb method, *e.g* Hwang, Kim, and Rudd (1996) and Kim and Rudd (1994), show that limit of the BEB method regard the electronic atom size rather than the molecule size (see subsubsection 3.1.5). That is why we also got a good agreement with more complex HAPs like pyrene. In theory, one would be able to modelise

3.1.2 Nitrogen bearing molecules

Ca fonctionne pour celle de la litt mais en plus nous on a des trucs de zinzin fou genre le proprionytil ou les trucs en 3D

3.1.3 Oxygen bearing molecules

Ca marche

3.1.4 Sulfur and phosphorus bearing molecules

Ca marche et ca marche meme "mieux" que Gaches et al. (2024) pcq on a l'ECP. Pour les molécules concernées ca colle niquel. Par contre H2S aucune idée de pourquoi c'est décalé un peu Benef pour PH3, y'a 0 papier expérimentaux mais on colle bien au indiens

3.1.5 Heavy elements bearing molecules

Le germane et le selane, jsp quoi dire d'autre ? Trouver data sur le sujet

3.2 Impact of isomery on TICS calculation

A few papers shown that isomery should affect TICS.

3.3 Applications to mass spectrometry

Ici trouver une idée

4 Conclusion

In this paper we presented a computational pipeline for calculating theoritical total ionisation cross section of 260 neutral molecules.

Multiple outlook could be imaginated:

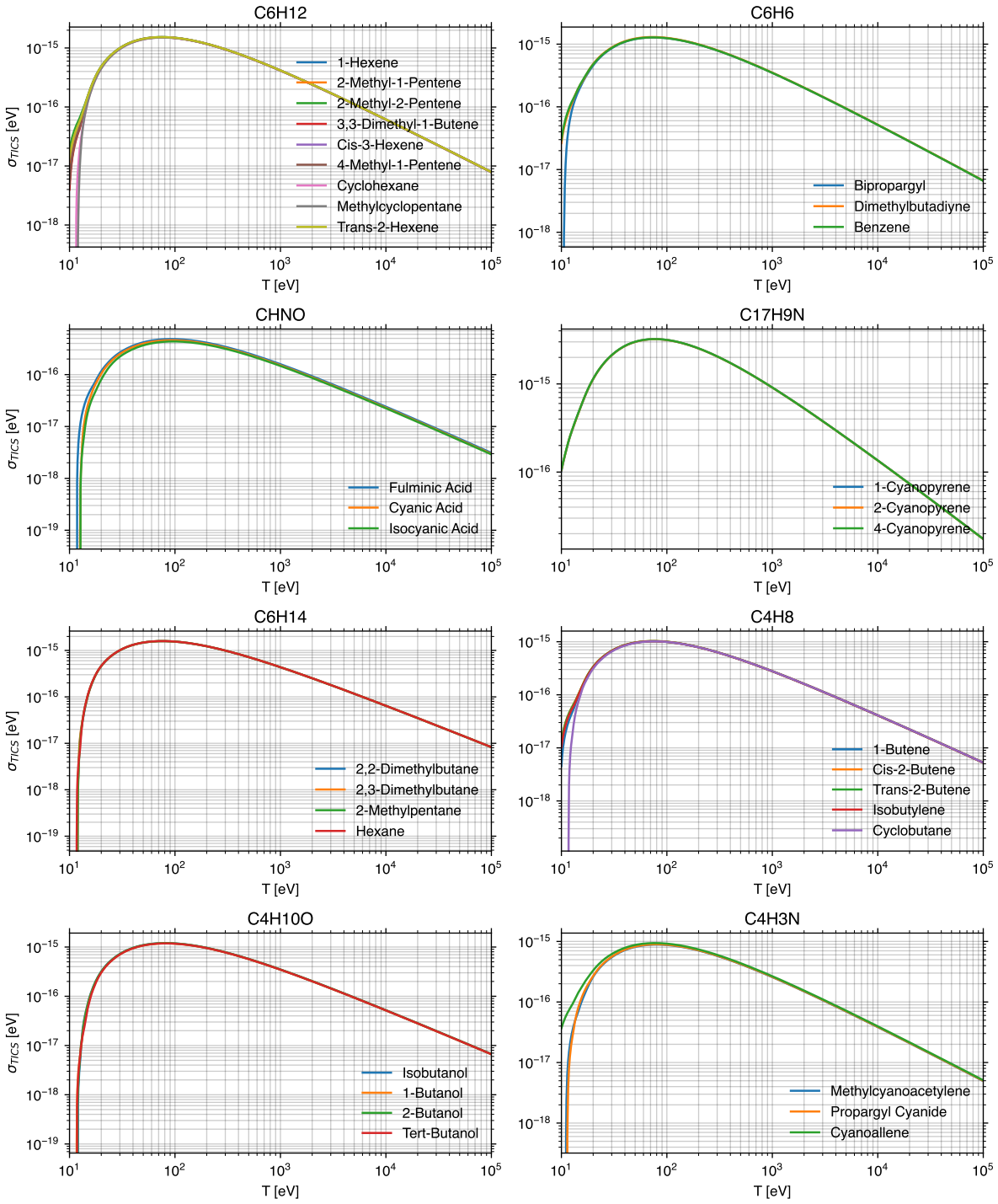


Figure 6 | dfbsdkfgk

- Adapt the pipeline for radicals (*i.e* molecules with spin $\neq 0$) and ions; This would require to do calculation using an Unrestricted Hatree-Fock (UHF) approach;
- Adapt and create a custom `def2-` ECP basis for $3d$ and $4p$ elements in order to homogenize the database as much as possible protocol-wise;
- CCSD(T) calculation would enable better IP values for dBEB calculations.

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Open science declarations

Author contributions. List here the details of each of the author's contributions to the work using the Contributor Role Taxonomy (CRediT, https://credit.niso.org/). These roles include: Conceptualization, Data curation, Formal analysis, Funding acquisition, Investigation, Methodology, Project administration, Resources, Software, Supervision, Validation, Visualization, Writing (original draft), and Writing (review & editing). Only those roles that are appropriate should be specified. These roles are summarized in the journal's authorship policies: https://planetary-research.org/authorship.

Code availability. Numerical codes must both be findable and accessible according to FAIR principles (https://www.go-fair.org/fair-principles/). Findable means that the code can be located using a persistent identifier, such as a software heritage identifier SWHID, an astrophysics source code library identifier ASCL, or a DOI. The conditions under which the code and software used in a manuscript can be accessed must be described either on the landing page of the code or in the code archive. If the code is restricted and requires credentials to be accessed, the exact conditions under which the credentials can be obtained should be provided. For further information, see the journal's Open Science policies: https://planetary-research.org/open-science.

Data availability. Any data that were used or generated as part of the study and that are not found in the manuscript and supplement must be uploaded to a public data repository before the article is accepted for publication. The datasets and any accompanying metadata and documentation should be made available to the reviewers during the peer-review process. For further information, see the journal's Open Science policies: https://planetary-research.org/open-science.

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Competing interests. All manuscripts must declare any real or perceived conflicts of interest. Competing interests may include both financial and non-financial interests such as past or present employment, consulting activity, financing, intellectual property, ownership of financial assets, or advisory roles. In the case where there are no competing interests, one can use the statement: The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

A Optimization of PubChem geometries

To see if pubchem geometries require optmization, we chose several molecules

Table B1 | Comparison of the energy of the ionization potential between this work (Δ)DFT and Gaches et al. (2024) CCSD(T) and CAM-B3LYP calculations for first ionization potential IP.

Molecule	ΔDFT	Gaches et al. (2024) (CCSD(T))	Gaches et al. (2024) (DFT)
CO	14,84	14,13	14,24
H_2	16,23	16,45	
H_2S	10,45	10,52	10,43
H_2O	13,87	12,8	12,69
O_3	13,26	13,02	12,77
C_2H_2	13,48	11,54	11,28
C_2N_2	13,48	14,74	13,25
C_3H_2O	11,59		10,59
CH_2O	12,15	11,04	10,88
CH_2S	9,61	9,5	9,3
NH_3	11,73	11,04	10,22
CH_4	14,80		12,72
C_2H_4	10,25		10,4
N_2H_4	10,46		6,82
C_4N_2	12,08		11,67
$c-H_2C_3O$	10,54		9,54
CH_3NS	9,04		9,45
C_4H_2	10,14		9,96
C_2H_6	13,19		11,59
C_6N_2	11,25		10,69
C_4H_4	9,39		9,32
C_5H_4	9,64		10,03
C_3H_8	12,74		10,99
C_4H_{10}	12,28		10,89
$c-C_6H_6$	9,16		9,17
$C_{14}H_{10}$	6,74		7,21
C_5H_{12}	11,95		10,76
C_6H_{14}	11,69		10,77

B Energy of first ionisation IP

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